

AUDITOR SUPPORT TOOL

Weekend Postings

Test code	GL-003	Category	General Ledger
Logic version	1.0.0	Test type	Exception identification

Purpose

This test identifies transactions dated on a Saturday or Sunday in the submitted transaction data. Weekend postings may indicate unusual processing, activity outside normal working arrangements, automated system activity, delayed posting, period-end adjustments or transactions processed when normal supervision may be reduced.

The result is an indicator for further audit scrutiny. It does not, by itself, confirm an error, unauthorised activity or fraud.

Risk addressed

The test addresses the risk that transactions may be processed outside normal operating periods, without expected review or approval, or recorded in an inappropriate accounting period. It may also identify unusual access, automated processing or weaknesses in controls over transaction timing and authorisation.

Relevant audit assertions

Occurrence	A weekend posting may not represent a transaction processed through expected normal procedures.
Cut-off	The transaction may have been recorded in an inappropriate accounting period or with an incorrect date.
Other possible assertions	Accuracy and classification may also be relevant, depending on the circumstances.

Data required

Mandatory	Transaction Date
Recommended	Journal Number, Account Code, Description, Debit Amount, Credit Amount, Net Amount, Cost Centre, Prepared By, Approved By, Source Module, Vendor Number, Employee Number and Invoice Number.

How the test works

- Blank transaction dates are excluded from weekend testing and disclosed separately.
- Transaction dates are validated and converted to a consistent date format.
- The day of the week is determined for each valid transaction date.
- Transactions dated on a Saturday or Sunday are flagged.
- All related transaction records are returned for auditor review, with the applicable day shown.

Exception wording: Weekend posting - further scrutiny required.

How to interpret the results

A weekend posting may be legitimate where the organisation operates during weekends, a transaction is generated automatically, approved overtime or emergency processing occurred, or month-end or year-end procedures were performed. The date recorded in the ledger may also differ from the date on which the transaction was entered. The auditor should consider the organisation's operating arrangements, source of the transaction, approval evidence and relevant system information before reaching a conclusion.

Suggested follow-up

- Confirm whether weekend processing was expected for the organisation or transaction type.
- Compare the transaction date with supporting-document, approval and system-entry dates where available.
- Inspect supporting documents and approval evidence for selected transactions.
- Determine whether the posting was manual, automated, recurring or batch-generated.
- Review the preparer, approver, source module, account and amount for unusual patterns.
- Assess whether access, authorisation and period-end controls operated effectively.

Professional basis

This procedure may support the identification and assessment of risks, the design of audit responses, the use of analytical procedures and the collection of audit evidence. Relevant references include ISSAI 2315, ISSAI 2330, ISSAI 2500 and ISSAI 2520. Where intentional manipulation is suspected, ISSAI 2240 may also be relevant. The AFROSAI-E Regularity Audit Manual recognises computer-assisted audit techniques and requires substantive procedures to be documented and supported by sufficient appropriate audit evidence.

Limitation

This test identifies transactions whose mapped date falls on a Saturday or Sunday only. It does not establish when the transaction was physically entered unless a separate system timestamp is available, and it does not prove that the transaction was unauthorised, erroneous or fraudulent. Public holidays and after-hours activity require separate tests. Final conclusions must be based on supporting audit evidence and professional judgement.

Reference

AFROSAI-E, Regularity Audit Manual, 2013, particularly the guidance on computer-assisted audit techniques, detailed planning and fieldwork, substantive audit procedures and audit evidence.